Healing Lunch Box

BONUS BOOK 1

30 Days of Allergy-Free School Lunches & Snacks Kids Will Actually Eat



30 lunch boxes

Gluten-free | Dairy-free | Corn-free | Egg-free | Caffeine-free | Tuna-free | Pork-free | Processed sugar-free | Nut-free

Nut-free and school-safe.

BY

Tris Eliverson

WELCOME

A lunch box made with love



Dear Mama, dear Papa,

I know the feeling of packing a lunch box and wondering if it will come home untouched. I know the worry of sending your child to school with allergies, and the little ache when everyone else has biscuits and crisps.

These 30 lunch boxes are the ones that work in my home. They are safe, simple and fun — familiar Nigerian favourites next to nuggets, pinwheels and pizza bites that children are proud to open in front of their friends.

Every box is free from gluten, dairy, corn, eggs, caffeine, tuna, pork, processed sugar **and nuts**, so it is school-safe.

Pack it with love. That's the most important ingredient. ♥

With love, Tris Eliverson

AUTISM MUM · RECIPE CREATOR

INSIDE THIS BOOK

Contents

A lunch box made with love 2

7 golden lunch box rules 4

The picky eater playbook 5

Lunch box pantry list 6

Your month at a glance 7

The 30 lunch boxes 8

10 snacks kids can't say no to 18

Naija snack corner 19

Thirty happy lunches 21

BEFORE YOU START

7 golden lunch box rules

A good lunch box is safe, simple and fun. Follow these 7 golden rules and lunchtime gets easier for everyone.

1. **Pack the night before**
   Mornings are busy. Pack everything except hot food the evening before.

2. **One safe food + one new food**
   Always include a food your child already loves. Put the new food beside it — no pressure.

3. **Keep it cold — or hot**
   Use an ice pack for cold boxes and a thermos for warm food like jollof or soup.

4. **Every box is nut-free**
   Most schools are nut-free. We use sunflower-seed butter instead of peanut butter.

5. **Tell the teacher**
   Give the school a copy of the allergy card from the Printables pack.

6. **Small and colourful wins**
   Small portions, bright colours and fun shapes. Cookie cutters are your best friend.

7. **Let them choose**
   Offer two choices: “Nuggets or pinwheels tomorrow?” Children eat what they choose.

FOR PICKY EATERS

The picky eater playbook

If your child eats only a few foods, you are not doing anything wrong. Many children — especially autistic children — feel safer with food that is predictable. These gentle tricks help.

1. Food chaining

Start from a food they love and change **one small thing** at a time:
shop nuggets → homemade nuggets → nuggets with paprika → chicken strips → chicken skewers.

2. Same food, new shape

Cut sandwiches, fruit and flatbread with cookie cutters. Stars, hearts and dinosaurs make the same food feel new.

3. The learning portion

Put one tiny piece of a new food in its own section. No need to eat it — just let it sit there. It can take 15 or more tries.

4. Respect the senses

Keep foods separate, offer dips, and notice what your child prefers: crunchy or soft, warm or cold, smooth or lumpy.

5. Let them help

Children eat what they choose, wash, pack or build. Offer two choices: “Pinwheels or nuggets tomorrow?”

6. Praise the try

Celebrate touching, smelling or licking a new food — not just eating it. Use the “I tried it!” chart in Healing Printables.

When to ask for extra help

If your child eats fewer than 20 foods, is losing weight, gags or vomits often, or mealtimes cause great distress, ask your doctor about a feeding therapist. You don't have to do this alone.

STOCK UP ONCE

Lunch box pantry list

Keep these in the kitchen and freezer and you can pack a safe lunch in minutes.

Batch-cook & freeze

- [ ] Chicken nuggets
- [ ] Mini meatballs
- [ ] Baked akara bites
- [ ] Mini moi moi cups
- [ ] Mama's chicken, potato & carrot soup
- [ ] Banana bread bites

Carbs

- [ ] Rice & rice pasta
- [ ] Cassava flour (for flatbreads)
- [ ] Easy Buckwheat Bread
- [ ] Sweet potatoes
- [ ] Ripe & green plantains
- [ ] Plain rice crackers (check: no corn)

Fruit

- [ ] Apples, bananas, grapes
- [ ] Mango, pineapple, watermelon
- [ ] Berries
- [ ] Oranges & tangerines

Vegetables

- [ ] Cucumber, carrots, peppers
- [ ] Cherry tomatoes
- [ ] Lettuce
- [ ] Peas & broccoli

Dips

- [ ] Coconut yogurt
- [ ] Hummus (contains sesame)
- [ ] Sunflower-seed butter
- [ ] Guacamole
- [ ] Sunshine Ketchup (no sugar)

Crunch

- [ ] Baked plantain chips (ipekere)
- [ ] Crunchy chickpeas
- [ ] Pumpkin & sunflower seeds
- [ ] Toasted coconut chips

Kit

- [ ] Bento box with sections
- [ ] Small thermos
- [ ] Ice pack
- [ ] Silicone cupcake cases
- [ ] Cookie cutters
- [ ] Paper straws & blunt picks

YOUR MONTH AT A GLANCE

30 lunch boxes

1 L Nugget happy box	**2** L Pizza pinwheels	**3** L Rainbow rice balls	**4** L Turkey roll-ups	**5** L Meatball skewers	**6** L Jollof thermos	**7** L DIY “lunchable”
8 L Mama's soup thermos	**9** L Moi moi & dodo	**10** L Rainbow pasta salad	**11** L Shawarma pinwheels	**12** L Fish finger box	**13** L Mama's pasta thermos	**14** L Akara bites & mango
15 L Fried rice thermos	**16** L Turkey sliders	**17** L Suya sticks & dodo	**18** L Mac bites box	**19** L Chicken potato salad	**20** L Pancakes for lunch	**21** L Beans & dodo thermos
22 L Rice paper rolls	**23** L Coconut curry thermos	**24** L Jollof spaghetti	**25** L Pizza wedges	**26** L Build-a-taco box	**27** L Coconut rice & fish	**28** L Hummus dippers
29 L Picnic box	**30** L Celebration box					

DAY 1 Chicken Nugget Happy Box

Prep the night before

YOU NEED

- [ ] 6 homemade chicken nuggets
- [ ] Handful of sweet potato wedges
- [ ] Apple slices + squeeze of lemon
- [ ] Cucumber sticks
- [ ] 2 tbsp Sunshine Ketchup

STEPS

1. Coat chicken pieces in olive oil, then cassava flour, paprika and salt.
2. Bake with the wedges at 220 °C / 425 °F for 15–18 min.
3. Sunshine Ketchup: simmer 1 cup passata, 2 chopped dates, pinch of salt and a splash of apple cider vinegar for 10 min; blend.
4. Morning: pack everything, ketchup in a little pot for dipping.

Why it helps: A homemade "happy meal" with no egg, no wheat and no added sugar.

Picky eater trick: Cut apple slices with a heart cookie cutter. Shapes make food fun.

DAY 2 Mini Pizza Pinwheels

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cassava flatbread or tortilla
- [ ] 2 tbsp tomato passata + pinch oregano
- [ ] 2 tbsp dairy-free cheese, grated
- [ ] A few shreds of cooked chicken
- [ ] Grapes (halved for under-5s)
- [ ] Carrot sticks

STEPS

1. Spread passata over the flatbread. Sprinkle oregano, cheese and chicken.
2. Roll up tightly and slice into 6 rounds.
3. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 8 min — or pack cold.
4. Pack with the grapes and carrots.

Why it helps: All the pizza flavour kids love, in a fun swirl shape.

DAY 3 Rainbow Rice Ball Bento

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup cooked short-grain rice
- [ ] ½ cup shredded cooked chicken
- [ ] Pinch of salt
- [ ] Cucumber coins
- [ ] Strawberries & mango cubes
- [ ] Coconut yogurt dip

STEPS

1. Mix the warm rice with chicken and salt.
2. With wet hands, roll into 6 small balls.
3. Pack each food in its own section, sorted by colour.
4. Add the dip in a small pot.

Why it helps: Separate sections are perfect for children who don't like foods touching.

Fun idea: Ask your child to "eat the rainbow" — one bite of every colour.

DAY 4 Turkey & Avocado Roll-Ups

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cassava flatbread or tortilla
- [ ] ½ avocado, mashed
- [ ] 3 slices homemade roast turkey or chicken
- [ ] Lettuce leaf, grated carrot
- [ ] Blueberries
- [ ] Baked plantain chips

STEPS

1. Spread avocado over the flatbread.
2. Layer turkey, lettuce and carrot.
3. Roll tightly and cut into 2-bite pieces.
4. Pack with blueberries and plantain chips.

Why it helps: Homemade meat avoids the nitrates found in most deli slices.

DAY 5 Mini Meatball Skewers

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 250 g beef mince
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] 2 tbsp cassava flour
- [ ] 2 tbsp grated courgette (hidden veg!)
- [ ] ½ tsp garlic powder, salt
- [ ] Cherry tomatoes, cucumber
- [ ] Tomato dip

STEPS

1. Mix mince, flax egg, flour, courgette and seasoning.
2. Roll into 12 small balls.
3. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 15 min. Cool.
4. Thread onto paper straws or blunt picks with halved tomatoes and cucumber.

Why it helps: Food on a stick is fun — and the courgette is hidden inside.

Time saver: Make a double batch and freeze half for next week.

DAY 6 Jollof Rice & Chicken Thermos

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup leftover jollof rice
- [ ] 3–4 pieces baked chicken
- [ ] Watermelon cubes
- [ ] Carrot sticks

STEPS

1. Heat the jollof and chicken until piping hot in the morning.
2. Fill the thermos with boiling water for 5 min, empty it, then add the food — it stays warm until lunch.
3. Pack the watermelon and carrots separately.

Why it helps: A familiar home favourite makes lunchtime feel safe for sensitive eaters.

DAY 7 DIY “Lunchable” Box

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 6 plain rice crackers (check: no corn)
- [ ] 4 slices homemade roast chicken
- [ ] 6 cubes dairy-free cheese
- [ ] Cucumber coins, grapes
- [ ] 2 Sunshine Bliss Balls

STEPS

1. Bliss balls: blitz 1 cup dates, ½ cup sunflower seeds and 2 tbsp coconut; roll into balls.
2. Arrange crackers, chicken, cheese and cucumber in rows.
3. Add grapes and bliss balls.

Why it helps: Kids build their own “cracker stacks” — and feel in charge of their food.

Allergy note: Shop-bought lunch kits contain dairy, wheat and nitrates. This one is clean.

DAY 8 Mama's Soup Thermos

Author's family favourite
Use frozen soup

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 portion Mama's Chicken, Potato & Carrot Soup
- [ ] 2 slices buckwheat bread, cut into soldiers
- [ ] Cucumber sticks
- [ ] Apple slices + squeeze of lemon

STEPS

1. Heat the soup until piping hot.
2. Warm the thermos with boiling water for 5 min, empty, then fill with soup.
3. Pack the bread soldiers, cucumber and apple separately.

Why it helps: My child's favourite soup — all the vegetables blended in, so nothing to pick out.

Time saver: Freeze soup in single portions on Sunday. Lunch is ready all week.

DAY 9 Mini Moi Moi & Dodo Box

Prep ahead

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 egg-free mini moi moi cups (steamed in silicone cases)
- [ ] Handful baked dodo bites
- [ ] Cucumber coins
- [ ] Watermelon cubes

STEPS

1. Steam moi moi in silicone cases 35–40 min. Cool and refrigerate (or freeze).
2. Bake ripe plantain cubes in a little coconut oil at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20 min.
3. Pack moi moi, dodo, cucumber and watermelon in separate sections.

Why it helps: A taste of home — beans set perfectly without egg and are full of plant protein.

DAY 10 Rainbow Pasta Salad Pot

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup cooked rice pasta (cold)
- [ ] ½ cup cooked chicken, diced
- [ ] Cucumber, cherry tomatoes, pepper — diced
- [ ] 1 tbsp olive oil + squeeze of lemon + pinch of salt
- [ ] Grapes (halved for under-5s)

STEPS

1. Toss pasta, chicken and vegetables.
2. Stir through olive oil, lemon and salt.
3. Pack with a small pot of grapes.

Why it helps: Colourful, cold and easy to eat with a fork — no soggy bread.

DAY 11 Chicken Shawarma Pinwheels

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cassava flatbread
- [ ] ½ cup cooked shawarma-spiced chicken, sliced
- [ ] 1 tbsp garlic coconut yogurt sauce
- [ ] Lettuce, grated carrot
- [ ] Orange segments

STEPS

1. Spread the yogurt sauce over the flatbread.
2. Add chicken, lettuce and carrot.
3. Roll tightly and slice into 6 pinwheels.
4. Pack with orange segments.

Why it helps: A Naija favourite in a fun swirl — no wheat wrap, no mayonnaise.

DAY 12 Fish Finger Box

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 baked fish fingers (cassava crumb)
- [ ] 2 tbsp minty pea dip (peas blended with olive oil)
- [ ] Carrot sticks
- [ ] Grapes

STEPS

1. Bake extra fish fingers at dinner and chill.
2. Blend cooked peas with olive oil, mint and salt for the dip.
3. Pack everything with the dip in a little pot.

Why it helps: White fish is gentle, low in mercury and great cold or warm.

DAY 13 Mama's Pasta Thermos

Author's family favourite
Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 portion Mama's Pasta with Meat & Tomato Sauce
- [ ] Cucumber sticks
- [ ] Banana

STEPS

1. Heat the pasta and sauce until piping hot.
2. Warm the thermos with boiling water, empty, then fill.
3. Pack cucumber and a banana.

Why it helps: A dinner my child asks for again and again — just as good at lunchtime.

DAY 14 Akara Bites & Mango Box

Prep ahead

YOU NEED

- [ ] 5 baked akara bites
- [ ] 2 tbsp tomato dip
- [ ] Mango cubes
- [ ] Cucumber sticks

STEPS

1. Bake akara bites in a mini muffin tin (see Naija Snack Corner). Cool.
2. Pack with the tomato dip, mango and cucumber.

Why it helps: Akara is naturally gluten-free and egg-free — and baked, not fried.

DAY 15 Rainbow Fried Rice Thermos

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup chicken fried rice (no sweetcorn)
- [ ] Extra peas & diced carrot
- [ ] Pineapple chunks

STEPS

1. Reheat the fried rice with a splash of water until steaming.
2. Fill a pre-warmed thermos.
3. Pack pineapple separately.

Why it helps: Shop fried rice often has sweetcorn and soy sauce — this one has neither.

DAY 16 Mini Turkey Burger Sliders

Prep ahead

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 mini turkey burgers (cooked & chilled)
- [ ] 2 small rounds of buckwheat bread or lettuce “buns”
- [ ] Cucumber slices
- [ ] Sweet potato fries (baked)
- [ ] Sunshine Ketchup

STEPS

1. Make mini burgers with the turkey burger recipe in Healing Plates.
2. Sandwich each in bread rounds or lettuce leaves.
3. Pack with fries, cucumber and a dip.

Why it helps: Kids feel grown-up with a mini burger — and it's completely safe.

DAY 17 Chicken Suya Sticks & Dodo

Prep ahead

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 nut-free chicken suya sticks (mild)
- [ ] Baked dodo bites
- [ ] Sliced cucumber & tomato
- [ ] Tangerine

STEPS

1. Rub chicken strips with ginger, paprika, garlic and onion powder (no groundnut, little pepper).
2. Bake at 220 °C / 425 °F for 12–15 min. Cool.
3. Pack with dodo, salad and fruit.

Why it helps: All the suya flavour, without the groundnut — school-safe.

DAY 18 Butternut Mac Bites Box

Prep ahead

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 butternut mac bites
- [ ] Steamed broccoli florets
- [ ] Apple slices
- [ ] Coconut yogurt dip

STEPS

1. Spoon leftover butternut “mac & cheese” into a muffin tin.
2. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 15 min until set.
3. Cool, then pack with broccoli, apple and dip.

Why it helps: Golden, cheesy-tasting bites with squash hidden inside.

DAY 19 Roast Chicken & Potato Salad Box

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] Leftover roast chicken pieces
- [ ] ½ cup cooked potatoes, cubed
- [ ] 2 tbsp coconut yogurt + chives + lemon
- [ ] Peas, cherry tomatoes
- [ ] Grapes

STEPS

1. Mix potatoes with coconut yogurt, chives, lemon and salt.
2. Add peas.
3. Pack with chicken, tomatoes and grapes.

Why it helps: Creamy potato salad with no egg mayonnaise.

DAY 20 Pancakes-for-Lunch Box

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 mini banana buckwheat pancakes
- [ ] Small pot of coconut yogurt
- [ ] Berries
- [ ] 1 tbsp sunflower-seed butter (dip)

STEPS

1. Make extra pancakes at breakfast and cool.
2. Pack with yogurt, berries and the seed-butter dip.

Why it helps: Breakfast-for-lunch feels like a treat — and it's still a balanced meal.

DAY 21 Beans & Dodo Thermos

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 portion beans & ripe plantain porridge
- [ ] Cucumber sticks
- [ ] Orange segments

STEPS

1. Reheat the beans until steaming.
2. Fill a pre-warmed thermos.
3. Pack cucumber and orange separately.

Why it helps: Honey beans are naturally sweet and full of fibre — filling all afternoon.

DAY 22 Rainbow Rice Paper Rolls

20 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 rice paper sheets
- [ ] Cooked chicken strips
- [ ] Cucumber, carrot, pepper — thin sticks
- [ ] Lettuce, mango strips
- [ ] Coconut aminos dip

STEPS

1. Dip a rice paper sheet in warm water for 10 seconds.
2. Fill with chicken, vegetables and mango.
3. Fold the sides in and roll tightly.
4. Pack with a little pot of coconut aminos.

Why it helps: See-through rolls let children see exactly what's inside — no surprises.

Allergy note: Check the rice paper label: rice, tapioca, salt and water only.

DAY 23 Coconut Chicken Curry Thermos

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 portion mild coconut chicken curry
- [ ] ½ cup rice
- [ ] Cucumber coins
- [ ] Mango

STEPS

1. Reheat the curry and rice until piping hot.
2. Fill a pre-warmed thermos.
3. Pack cucumber and mango.

Why it helps: Mild, creamy and warming — turmeric and ginger are gentle on tummies.

DAY 24 Jollof Spaghetti Thermos

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 portion jollof spaghetti with chicken
- [ ] Carrot sticks
- [ ] Watermelon

STEPS

1. Reheat until steaming.
2. Fill a pre-warmed thermos.
3. Pack carrot sticks and watermelon.

Why it helps: Jollof + pasta = a lunch box that always comes home empty.

DAY 25 Pizza Quesadilla Wedges

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cassava flatbread
- [ ] 2 tbsp passata + pinch oregano
- [ ] 2 tbsp dairy-free cheese
- [ ] Cooked chicken, chopped
- [ ] Cherry tomatoes, grapes

STEPS

1. Spread passata on half the flatbread. Add cheese and chicken.
2. Fold over and toast in a dry pan 2 min each side.
3. Cool and cut into 4 wedges.
4. Pack with tomatoes and grapes.

Why it helps: Pizza flavour in a crispy wedge — easy to hold and eat.

DAY 26 Build-a-Taco Box

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 small cassava flatbreads
- [ ] Taco-spiced beef mince (cold or in thermos)
- [ ] Shredded lettuce, diced tomato
- [ ] 2 tbsp guacamole
- [ ] Dairy-free cheese, grated

STEPS

1. Pack each filling in its own section.
2. Add the flatbreads folded in half.
3. Your child builds their own tacos at lunch.

Why it helps: Building their own lunch gives children control — and they eat more.

DAY 27 Coconut Rice & Fish Bites

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup coconut rice
- [ ] 4 baked fish bites (white fish, cassava crumb)
- [ ] Cucumber & tomato salad
- [ ] Pineapple

STEPS

1. Cut fish into bites, coat and bake at 220 °C / 425 °F for 10 min.
2. Pack rice and fish bites.
3. Add salad and pineapple.

Why it helps: Coconut rice makes fish feel like a party.

DAY 28 Hummus Dipper Box

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 tbsp hummus
- [ ] Cucumber, carrot & pepper sticks
- [ ] 6 plain rice crackers (no corn)
- [ ] Cooked chicken pieces
- [ ] Grapes

STEPS

1. Spoon hummus into a small pot.
2. Arrange vegetables, crackers and chicken around it.
3. Add grapes.

Why it helps: Dipping makes vegetables fun — even for veggie-shy children.

Allergy note: Hummus contains sesame. If sesame is a problem, use guacamole instead.

DAY 29 Picnic Box

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 chicken skewers (cold)
- [ ] Egg-free potato salad
- [ ] Rainbow fruit kebab on a paper straw
- [ ] Plantain chips

STEPS

1. Pack the skewers and potato salad.
2. Thread fruit onto a paper straw.
3. Add a handful of plantain chips.

Why it helps: A little picnic in a box — perfect for sunny days and school trips.

DAY 30 Day 30 Celebration Box

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] Mini portion of party jollof
- [ ] Baked chicken piece
- [ ] Baked dodo
- [ ] 1 banana bread bite
- [ ] A note: “You did it! 30 days!”

STEPS

1. Pack the jollof, chicken and dodo.
2. Add a banana bread bite as a treat.
3. Tuck in a little note or sticker to celebrate.

Why it helps: Thirty days of safe, happy lunches — that's worth celebrating!

SNACK ATTACK

10 snacks kids can't say no to

Bright, crunchy, dippable and fun. These snacks are made for even the pickiest eaters — nut-free, processed-sugar-free and free from every food in this book.

1. Veggie Tots

Mash 1 sweet potato with ½ grated courgette and 3 tbsp tapioca flour. Shape into little logs, bake 20 min at 200 °C.

2. Fruit Nachos

Thin apple slices on a plate, drizzled with warm sunflower-seed butter and carob syrup. Sprinkle coconut.

3. Banana Sushi

Spread coconut yogurt on a banana, roll in crushed pumpkin seeds, slice into "sushi" rounds.

4. Frozen Yogurt Bark

Spread coconut yogurt on parchment, dot with berries, freeze 3 hours and snap into pieces.

5. Apple "Donuts"

Slice apples into rings, core them, spread with sunflower-seed butter and add coconut "sprinkles".

6. Baked Plantain Chips

Very thin green plantain slices, olive oil and salt. Bake 15–20 min at 190 °C until crisp.

7. Crunchy Chickpeas

Dry a tin of chickpeas, toss with oil, paprika and salt. Bake 30 min at 200 °C.

8. Sunshine Bliss Balls

Blitz dates, sunflower seeds and coconut. Roll into balls. No nuts, no sugar added.

9. Pancake Skewers

Leftover mini pancakes and strawberries threaded onto paper straws.

10. Cucumber Pizza Coins

Thick cucumber rounds topped with a dab of hummus and chopped tomato.

Carob instead of chocolate

Chocolate and cocoa contain caffeine. Carob tastes chocolatey, is naturally sweet and caffeine-free.

TASTE OF HOME

Naija snack corner

Our favourite Nigerian snacks — made gluten-free, egg-free, nut-free, processed-sugar-free and baked instead of deep-fried. Familiar tastes from home that are safe for school.

1. Ipekere (Plantain Chips)

Thin green plantain slices, a little oil and salt. Bake 15–20 min at 190 °C until crisp.

2. Baked Dodo Bites

Ripe plantain cubes tossed in a little coconut oil. Bake 20 min at 200 °C, turning once.

3. Cassava Chin Chin

Crunchy, egg-free and wheat-free — baked, not fried. Full recipe over the page.

4. Baked Akara Bites

Fluffy bean balls baked in a mini muffin tin. Full recipe over the page.

5. Mini Moi Moi Cups

Egg-free moi moi steamed in silicone cupcake cases — the perfect lunch box size.

6. Nut-Free Chicken Suya Sticks

Chicken strips rubbed with ginger, paprika, garlic and onion powder (no groundnut). Bake 15 min at 220 °C.

7. Gizdodo Bites

Cooked gizzard and ripe plantain cubes in a light pepper sauce. Pack in a small thermos.

8. Dundun Fries

Yam sticks tossed in oil and salt, baked 25 min at 200 °C. Crispy outside, soft inside.

9. Ofio & Coconut Mix

Soaked tiger nuts with toasted coconut chips. Tiger nuts are tubers, not nuts — school-safe.

10. Zobo Ice Pops

Hibiscus zobo with pineapple and ginger, sweetened with dates. Freeze in moulds — no sugar, no caffeine.

Watch out for

Shop-bought chin chin, puff-puff, meat pie and doughnuts (wheat & egg), kokoro and popcorn (corn), and kuli kuli (groundnut).

NAIJA SNACK

Crunchy Cassava Chin Chin

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups cassava flour
- [ ] 3 tbsp pure maple syrup
- [ ] ½ tsp ground nutmeg, pinch of salt
- [ ] ⅓ cup solid coconut oil
- [ ] About ⅓ cup coconut milk

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F. Line 2 trays with parchment.
2. Mix flour, nutmeg and salt. Rub in the coconut oil with your fingers.
3. Add the maple syrup, then coconut milk a little at a time, to make a firm dough.
4. Roll out 5 mm thick and cut into small squares.
5. Bake 15–20 min, stirring once, until golden. They crisp as they cool.

Why it helps: The chin chin every Nigerian child knows — with no wheat, no egg, no processed sugar and no deep frying.

Picky eater trick: Let your child cut the squares with a blunt knife. Kids eat what they make.

NAIJA SNACK

Baked Akara Bites

35 min + soaking

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups black-eyed beans, soaked & peeled
- [ ] 1 small onion
- [ ] ½ scotch bonnet (skip for young kids)
- [ ] ½ tsp salt
- [ ] 2–3 tbsp water
- [ ] Olive oil, for the tin

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 200 °C / 400 °F. Oil a mini muffin tin well.
2. Blend beans, onion, pepper and salt with very little water to a thick paste.
3. Whisk hard for 3 min until light and fluffy.
4. Spoon into the tin and bake 20–25 min until golden.
5. Cool and pack with a tomato dip.

Why it helps: Akara is naturally gluten-free and egg-free — full of plant protein.

Time saver: Bake a big batch on Sunday and freeze. Warm for 5 min before packing.

YOU DID IT

Thirty happy lunches

Thirty lunch boxes. Thirty days of your child eating safely at school — and maybe even trying something new.

Keep it going

- Start again at Day 1 — or repeat the family favourites.
- Swap any box for a leftover dinner from Healing Plates.
- Keep a stash of frozen nuggets, akara and soup for busy weeks.

Don't forget

- Give the school a copy of the allergy card (Healing Printables).
- Check labels every time — recipes change.
- Celebrate every new food tried.

With love, Tris Eliverson

AUTISM MUM · RECIPE CREATOR

© Tris Eliverson. All rights reserved. For personal use only — please do not share or resell. This book shares food ideas from personal experience and is not medical advice. Always check food labels and your school's food policy. Cut grapes, cherry tomatoes and other round foods lengthways for children under 5.